

In Next.js, the `localePrefix` value is a configuration setting primarily used by the [next-intl](#) library to control how locale segments appear in your application's URLs. [next-intl +1](#)

This value is defined within your routing configuration and typically accepts three main settings: [next-intl +1](#)

- **always** : Every URL will include the locale prefix, including the default locale (e.g., `/en/about` , `/fr/about`).
- **as-needed** : The locale prefix is hidden for the default locale but remains visible for all others (e.g., `/about` for English, `/fr/about` for French).
- **never** : No locale prefix is ever shown in the URL. In this setup, the locale is typically determined by other factors like cookies or domain-based routing (e.g., `/about` for all languages). [next-intl +5](#)

Implementation Example

To use this in a Next.js App Router project, you configure it in your [middleware](#) or a dedicated routing file: [next-intl +1](#)

typescript

```
import {defineRouting} from 'next-intl/routing';

export const routing = defineRouting({
  locales: ['en', 'de'],
  defaultLocale: 'en',
  localePrefix: 'as-needed' // Prefix only shown for 'de'
});
```

Key Considerations

- **Search Engine Optimization (SEO):** Using `always` or `as-needed` is generally recommended for SEO as it provides unique URLs for different language versions of a page.
- **Dynamic Segments:** If you set it to `never` , you must manually manage the `[locale]` dynamic segment in your directory structure (e.g., `app/[locale]/layout.tsx`).
- **Redirects:** When using `as-needed` , Next.js will automatically redirect users from a prefixed default locale URL (like `/en/about`) to the unprefixed version (`/about`). [next-intl +4](#)